MASTER FUNCTIONAL SKILLS

ESSENTIAL DIGITAL SKILLS QUALIFICATIONS

EDSQ L1 / E3

PRACTICAL STUDY HANDBOOK • 5 NATIONAL STANDARDS



DIGITAL SKILLS
PRACTICAL HANDBOOK

Complete practical handbook for Entry 3 & Level 1 EDSQ across all 5 National Standards

5 Standards | Cloud & Security | Workplace Tools | Exam Tasks

Phishing Detection & Online Safety Protocols

Skill Area 5 requires learners to identify suspicious communications, protect personal information, and demonstrate secure password protocols.

The 4 Red Flags of a Phishing Email:

- **Mismatched Sender Address:** The display name says "Your Bank", but the actual domain is `@secure-update-notice.xyz`.
- **Artificial Urgency:** Demands immediate action: "Account will be suspended within 24 hours".
- **Generic Greeting:** Uses "Dear Customer" instead of your actual registered name.
- **Suspicious Links:** Hovering reveals a destination URL completely unrelated to the authentic organization.

Safe Response Procedure:

1. Never click direct links or open unverified attachments.
2. Flag and report the email to your workplace IT administrator or spam filter.
3. If in doubt, navigate to the organization's official website independently via browser bookmark.

Master essential digital skills for work, study, and daily life

Mapped directly to the Department for Education (DfE) National National Standards for Essential Digital Skills. Features visual, screenshot-guided instructions for navigating devices, operating cloud systems, communicating professionally, and staying secure online.

INSIDE THIS PUBLICATION

- ✔ **All 5 National Digital Standards:** Using Devices & Handling Information, Creating & Editing, Communicating, Transacting, and Being Safe Online.
- ✔ **Hands-On Workplace Practicality:** File management, spreadsheets, formatting documents, email attachments, and online collaboration tools.
- ✔ **Cybersecurity & Online Safety:** Recognizing phishing emails, password hygiene, two-factor authentication, and data privacy rights.
- ✔ **Digital Transaction Protocols:** Booking appointments, online banking safely, evaluating credible web sources, and public services.
- ✔ **Authentic Practical Assessment Tasks:** Simulated exam scenarios calibrated to Gateway, Pearson, and NCFE EDSQ standards.

Official EDSQ Curriculum Alignment:

Aligned with the statutory National Standards for Essential Digital Skills at Entry Level 3 and Level 1. Ideal for college courses, adult education, and corporate digital literacy programs.

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